The Payson Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Turdas, the 15th of Frostfall (Thursday, October 15, 2026) · Morning Edition — Vol. 2610, No. 15 · Price: One Septim



Gandy basks through the breeze while Maevy hunts a tumbling leaf.

Skies o'er the Hold

67° / 51°

Sunny and clear, breezy

Sunrise 6:30 AM · Sunset 5:50 PM

Tomorrow — Sunny, 72/47

The Moon's Reckoning



Yesterday · *Tonight* · *Tomorrow*

Waxing Crescent

waxing toward the full moon

15th of Frostfall = October 15

Months run one-for-one all year

Sundas=Sun … Loredas=Sat

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Lanterns on the Lake Light the Hold Tonight

Payson, Ariz.

Hail, wayfarer, and good Turdas to you — the sun is up over the Rim, the pines are tossing in a brisk north-east breeze, and Payson is set for its biggest evening of the week. At sundown, lanterns take to the water at Green Valley Park for the sixth annual Lanterns on the Lake, while folk harmonies fill the hall with A Band Called Honalee and, down the road in Prescott Valley, Gary Allan takes the big stage. The days ahead brim with art walks, plein air painters, a mountain-bike poker run, and a film festival in the White Mountains — so eat hearty, traveler, and plan your quests.



Townsfolk launch their lanterns across the lake at sundown, as they will tonight at Green Valley Park.

Happening in the Holds Today

- **Payson**

  — Lanterns on the Lake — 6th Annual — 4 PM to sundown, Green Valley Park, 1000 W Country Club Dr. Time Out Shelter hosts this beloved gathering to raise awareness of domestic violence, and the whole Hold turns out for it. Food trucks and family activities run from 4 to 5:30 PM, with lantern decorating, face painting, and police and fire displays. The awareness walk steps off at 5:30 PM, and at sunset the decorated lanterns are launched across Green Valley Lake — a sight worth the whole trip.

  — A Band Called Honalee — 7 PM, 301 S McLane Rd, Payson. This modern-day folk trio relives the timeless magic of Peter, Paul and Mary, bringing classics the whole hall knows by heart to life with stirring vocal harmonies. The show also honors Dylan, Joni Mitchell, and other legends of the age. A warm Turdas evening of songs carried the way traveling bards once carried news between holds. Come ready to sing along under your breath.

- **Camp Verde**

  — Windmill Park Farmers Market in Cornville — until 6 PM, 9950 E Cornville Rd, Cornville, a short ride from Camp Verde. This small-town market spreads through a creekside park with fresh produce, sourdough breads and baked goods, farm eggs and local honey. Look also for goat-milk soaps, jams, pickled vegetables, mushrooms, flowers, herbs, and handmade crafts. Listed rain or shine, it is an easy, tasty stop for guests bound for Sedona or Camp Verde.

- **Sedona**

  — Sacred Qi Acupuncture Healing with Margarita Alcantara — 11 AM–5 PM, Shine Sanctuary Sedona, 162 Coffee Pot Dr, Unit D. A full daytime healing session on the sanctuary's own October calendar, part of Shine's regular rotation of acupuncture, energy, and sound-healing offerings. It is a calm, wellness-minded way to spend a red-rock day between hikes and galleries. Check the Shine calendar for booking details before you go, as sessions fill.

  — Renee Taylor Jewelry Buying Event — until 5:30 PM today, 313 AZ-179, Suite B14, Sedona. Estate Buying Specialists examine gold, coins, fine jewelry, diamonds, sterling silver, and watches, and give an honest evaluation on the spot. Sell, and payment is immediate — no appointment needed, just walk in. Today is the final day, so it is the last chance to turn a drawer of old treasures into septims for the road.

- **Prescott**

  — Gary Allan in concert — 7:30 PM, Findlay Toyota Center, 3201 N Main St, Prescott Valley, just east of Prescott. The country powerhouse brings nearly three decades of hits, including "Watching Airplanes" and "Every Storm (Runs Out of Rain)," delivered with his signature grit and soul. His sound blends traditional country with a rock edge built over decades on the road. It is a ticketed arena show, so buy ahead — the week's biggest headline concert for the Prescott hold.

The Days Ahead

- **Fri, Oct. 16**

  — **October Chamber Mixer** — 5 PM, The Rim Golf Club, 2000 E Rim Club Dr, Payson. The Rim Country Chamber's October mixer moves to the golf club for a business-and-neighbors social on Friday evening. Meet local shopkeepers, makers, and hosts over drinks in a handsome club setting. It is a fine window into who runs what in the Hold. Check the Chamber calendar for ticket and RSVP details before heading up the hill.

  — **3rd Friday Art Walk** — 4–6 PM, free, around 646 S 1st St, Camp Verde. Camp Verde's monthly third-Friday art walk returns for a relaxed, strollable early evening among local artists and downtown stops. It runs just two hours, so arrive on time and take it at a wanderer's pace. Pair it easily with dinner in Camp Verde or nearby Old Town Cottonwood. A gentle Friday outing for art-loving travelers.

  — **Sedona Plein Air Festival — 22nd Annual** — opens Friday and runs through Oct. 24, Sedona Arts Center, 15 Art Barn Rd, Sedona. Twenty-six invited artists paint the red rocks outdoors, in real time, across nine days. Watch canvases take shape in the very light you are standing in, at paint-out sites across the Verde Valley. A free live painting demo follows Saturday, Oct. 17, 10 AM–12 PM at Outbound Sedona, 1752 AZ-179.

- **Sat, Oct. 17**

  — **Highline Hold'em Mountain Bike Poker Run** — from 9 AM, Landmark at The Creek, 1177 Christopher Creek Loop, Payson. The sixth annual nine-mile poker run on the Highline Trail is run by the Rim Country Mountain Biking Association. Riders collect seven cards along the trail to make a five-card hand, and the best hands pick prizes back at the Landmark. Paid entry includes a 2026 T-shirt, and proceeds fund signage and care for the Highline's 63 miles.

  — **Arizona Blues Hall of Fame Northern Showcase** — 6 PM, Elks Theatre, 117 E Gurley St, Prescott. The third annual showcase brings three sets of Arizona Blues Hall of Fame performers to Prescott's historic stage. Headliner Big Pete Pearson brings his five-piece band, Tucson's Bad News Blues Band makes a rare northern appearance, and Big Daddy D and the Dynamites round out the night. A strong Saturday-night ticket for blues lovers and Valley Dwellers alike.

— **Show Low Film Festival** — festival weekend, Oct. 16–18, WME Village 8, 1501 W White Mountain Blvd, Pinetop-Lakeside. Now in its eighth year, this White Mountains festival screens its top independent films on the big screens, from shorts to features and documentaries. Filmmakers attend in person, with workshops across the weekend, and day passes and single-block tickets are on sale. Note the films are not yet rated, and the festival itself says it is not suggested for children.

— **Cowboy Prom for a Cause** — 5:30–8:30 PM, gates 5 PM, 3092 Jacks Rd, Pinetop-Lakeside. A benefit country night with live music from Heber Ridge, dancing, barbecue, and raffle and auction items, White Mountains style. Listings say proceeds support the Johnson family as they face a stage-three cancer diagnosis while raising two children. Admission is listed at $35 per person or $65 per couple. Boots and hats welcome — verify tickets on the event page before going.

- **Wed, Oct. 21**

  — **Lunch & Learn: Google Business Profile & the Value of Reviews** — Payson Unified School District, 902 W Main St, Payson. A midday learning session for local business owners on how a Google Business Profile and honest customer reviews bring travelers through the door. Most useful to hosts, shopkeepers, and guides who serve Hearth guests across Rim Country. It is listed for Wednesday, Oct. 21 in Payson's event roundups. Check the Chamber calendar for the start time and RSVP.

Quests of the Hearth

Quests awaiting:

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue since Sept. 26 — draw the sconces and ready them before a single torch can burn.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Overdue since Oct. 3 — the printers stand ready; give them their orders.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Overdue since Oct. 10 — hang the finished torches and light the way.
- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Due Saturday, Oct. 17 — the Hearth's arms take shape; mount it by the front door after.



The shield takes shape on the workbench while the torch sconces wait their turn.

The shield is due Saturday, Oct. 17 — and the torches still wait overdue, wanting their guardians hung and lit.

Merchant of the Hold

Carpenter's Wife Antiques · *Payson*



Thirteen rooms of treasure, stacked to the rafters like a trader's hoard.

A proper general-goods trader's shop for the Hold: thirteen rooms packed to the ceiling with antique furniture, home decor, collectibles, boutique clothing, antique books, candles, and Western and Native pieces, plus local jams and honey — and a backyard of rust-and-relics besides. Somewhere in the stacks a small enchantment keeps one more treasure tucked behind the last one you just found, every single time. Start with the room-by-room treasure hunt itself; it is the signature dish here.

> *"The most fantastic store in Payson."* — Phyllis N. on Yelp (via Roadtrippers)

112 W Wade Ln, Payson · Thu–Sat only, 10 AM–5 PM, closed Sun–Wed · (928) 472-7343 · $$ (moderate) · Good to know: it opens only Thursday through Saturday, so a long weekend stay is your window — call ahead on a special trip. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a 'website')

Why the Hearth sends you: A true Rim Country treasure hunt minutes from the Hearth — real antiques, Western pieces, and local honey in a shop that richly rewards slow browsing.

Tales from the Treeline

The Great Kite Trial



Flurry tows, Henny holds the line, and Gus calls it a triumph.

Turdas dawned sunny with a brisk wind worrying the pines, and Gus (a friendly orc baker) decided his new diamond kite ought to be tested before lunch, not after. "Wind waits for no pie," he said, which Mabel (a wood elf) noted was not a saying.

Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon) towed the kite aloft and, thanks to the famous kink in his tail, flew his usual zigzag — so the kite wrote delighted loops over the clearing while the string wound itself twice around Gus's hat. Henny (the Hearth's chicken) took charge of the string end with unbothered professionalism, marching backward one solemn step at a time, paying out line like a harbormaster.

When a gust finally set the kite down — gently, in Mabel's herb garden, atop the sage — nobody scolded anybody. Gus declared the trial a triumph, Flurry took a bow mid-air and landed in a leaf drift, and Henny kept the string. She appears to own a kite now.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Turdas be free of dragons, Clay.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com